R. SAI KISHORE, 28

***Left-arm orthodox*, Gujarat Titans**



He might well be considered the long-lost twin of New Zealand star Rachin Ravindra, if only for similar hairstyles. In domestic cricket, Sai Kishore has been an integral part of Tamil Nadu's resurgence in the last couple of years. The fact that Gujarat Titans used the RTM to retain him (after Punjab Kings upped the pot to Rs 2 crore) means the franchise sees great value in his presence. If the Tamil Nadu Ranji team captain can repeat his heroics from the domestic leagues last year, then Gujarat Titans will greatly benefit. At an impressive 6'3", Sai is also one of the few tall left arm tweakers operating in the IPL.

PTI



SURYANSH SHEDGE, 22

***Batter*, Punjab Kings**

Mumbai cricket's new Mr. Finisher. In the 2024 Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy, Suryansh Shedge stole the limelight for his brilliant finishing in a crunch situation. An average of 43 with a staggering strike-rate of 251 was the key reason why Mumbai won the tournament. Shedge is from the Sehwag see-ball-hit-ball school of batting, but in his elastic strokeplay, there is an element of Suryakumar Yadav too. If his domestic exploits from last year are anything to go by, then Punjab Kings have certainly acquired a show-stopper.

RYAN RICKELTON, 28

***Wicketkeeper-batsman*, Mumbai Indians**



AFP

Adam Gilchrist was Ryan Rickelton's boyhood hero, and the legend would be proud of the likeness. South Africa's emerging star played for the Mumbai Indians' Cape Town franchise, and with an average of 53 and a strike-rate in excess of 175 over two seasons, the left-handed wicketkeeper bat could be a big boost to MI's stable top order. The century in the Champions Trophy has already given us a glimpse of the 28-year-old's prowess.

VIJAYKUMAR VYSHAK, 28

***Right-arm pacer*, Punjab Kings**

Karnataka's Vijaykumar Vyshak made an immediate impression in his debut match in IPL 2023 against the Delhi Capitals, taking 3/20 and raising some heat. Surprisingly, his earlier franchise, RCB, did not take full advantage of the pacer's abilities, restricting him to 11 games in two seasons. The Bengaluru pacer was in top form in the 2024 Duleep Trophy too, troubling batters with his swing and accuracy. Now with the Punjab Kings, Vyshak is sure to be a key part of their bowling line-up.



ANI